

# MOBILE

## APPLICATION TESTING TOOLS

### You Should Know About

Mobile application testing is an important phase of mobile app development. In this article, the author explores a few open source mobile app testing tools and the types of tests that mobile apps undergo before they are marketed.



**M**obile application testing refers to the specialised process with which the application software developed by software engineers can be tested for functionality, security, usability and consistency. The testing of mobile apps can be automated or manual. They may be pre-installed with a fresh handset, or be installed from software distribution platforms and online repositories launched by network service providers.

Security testing is considered the most important factor of mobile apps testing, because with banking and financial services going online, mobile apps need to be secure to prevent malicious attacks.

#### Types of mobile application testing

Today, since almost every service is accessible via a mobile phone, there are a number of parameters on which mobile apps are tested, as any small error can ruin the reputation of mobile app providers.

The following are the testing techniques used for rigorous analysis of mobile apps.

**Usability testing:** This tests the user interface, and ensures that the mobile app is easy to use and provides a good user experience. Usability testing is carried out to verify if the application is achieving its goals and getting a favourable response from users. This is important, as the usability of an application is the key to its commercial success.

**Compatibility testing:** This tests the app on multiple platforms so that there is no problem linked to compatibility or portability. The testing of the application on multiple mobile devices,

Web browsers, screen resolutions and operating system versions is done based on requirements.

**Interface testing:** Interface testing is concerned with the analysis and testing of menus, sub-menus, menu options, buttons, hyper links, bookmarks, history, settings, navigation flow and other related components of the application.

**Services testing:** This tests the mobile application under different modes, including online and offline. With the help of these tests, the predictive behaviour of the mobile app is analysed.